

# THE COZY COTTAGE WORKBOOK

## Finding Calm in a Loud World

Featuring: Whisper the Bunny

This workbook belongs to the Sensory Super-Feeler:

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*(Sign your name gently, like a whisper)*

**MISSION:** To learn the secrets of the "Cozy Cocoon" and manage the Volume Dial.

**WARNING:** This book is designed to help you feel good. Soft markers recommended.

**Your Super Power:** "Super-Sensing" (Noticing *everything!*)

**Your Challenge:** The "Too Much" Feeling.

## PAGE 2: THE STORY

# THE STORY OF THE SENSITIVE BUNNY

Meet **Whisper**. Whisper is a bunny with **Super Ears**.

Whisper hears *everything*. The hum of the fridge. The scratch of a tag on a shirt. The bright lights in the grocery store.

Usually, this is a Super Power. Whisper can hear a leaf fall! But sometimes, the world feels too **LOUD**, too **BRIGHT**, or too **SCRATCHY**.

When that happens, Whisper's brain feels like a shaken-up soda bottle. This is called being **Overwhelmed**.

### YOUR TURN: DRAW THE "TOO MUCH"

What does it feel like when the world is too loud or busy for you?

Is it a thunderstorm? A tangled knot? A siren? Static on a TV?

Draw that feeling in the frame below.

*Turn the page to learn the Cozy Secrets to turn the volume down!*

## PAGE 3: TOOL #1 - THE VOLUME DIAL

# TOOL 1: THE VOLUME DIAL

**The Problem:** Sometimes we don't notice we are getting upset until we EXPLODE.

**The Solution:** The Volume Dial.

Your body has an invisible Volume Dial. It tells you how much energy or feeling you have inside right now.

### ACTIVITY: COLOR YOUR DIAL

Color the zones below:

1. **Low (Calm):** Color the bottom section **GREEN** or **BLUE**. (Feeling safe, quiet).
2. **Medium (Okay):** Color the middle section **YELLOW**. (Feeling alert, maybe a little annoyed).
3. **High (Too Much!):** Color the top section **RED** or **PINK**. (Feeling like you need to hide or yell).

### CHECK-IN:

Where is your arrow pointing *right now*?

[ ] Low (Calm)

[ ] Medium (Wobbly)

[ ] High (HELP!)

*Remember: You can check your dial anytime, without anyone knowing!*

## PAGE 4: TOOL #2 - THE COZY COCOON

# TOOL 2: THE COZY COCOON

**The Problem:** The world is too big and has too much going on.

**The Solution:** Build a Cozy Cocoon.

A Cozy Cocoon is a safe, small space where you control the sensory input. It helps your brain cool down.

### ACTIVITY: DESIGN YOUR COCOON

If you could build the perfect fort to hide in, what would be inside? Circle the items you need, and draw your own in the box!

- ☐ Soft Stuffie
- ☐ Quiet Headphones
- ☐ Weighted Blanket
- ☐ Dim Lights (or Sunglasses)
- ☐ Chewy Snack
- ☐ Fidget Spinner

### DRAW YOUR COCOON BLUEPRINT:

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<div style="border: 4px solid #F8BBD9; height: 250px; width: 100%; border-radius: 20px;"></div>
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*Secret Code: "I need to go to my Cocoon" means "I need a break!"*

## PAGE 5: TOOL #3 - GENTLE GROUNDING

# TOOL 3: GENTLE GROUNDING

**The Problem:** Your brain is floating away because of a loud noise or scary thought.

**The Solution:** Gentle Grounding.

We use our **5 Senses** to act like an anchor on a boat. They hold us steady in the "Right Now."

### ACTIVITY: THE SENSORY SCAVENGER HUNT

You are going to be a Detective. Look around the room you are in. Find one gentle thing for each sense.

1. 👁️ **SEE:** Find one thing that is a soft color (like blue or green).

*Write it here:* \_\_\_\_\_

2. 👂 **HEAR:** Close your eyes. Find one quiet sound (like a fan or your breath).

*Write it here:* \_\_\_\_\_

3. 🖐️ **TOUCH:** Find something soft or smooth to touch (your shirt, the table).

*Write it here:* \_\_\_\_\_

4. 👃 **SMELL:** Take a gentle sniff. What does the air smell like?

*Write it here:* \_\_\_\_\_

**Science Fact:** Using your senses tells your brain: *"You are safe. You are here."*

## PAGE 6: THE SUPER BRAIN (THE "WHY")

# YOUR BRAIN: THE GATEKEEPER

Why do you notice things other kids don't? It's because of your **Gatekeeper** (The Thalamus).

### The Normal Gatekeeper:

Imagine a doorman at a building. He stops the "boring" visitors (background noise, itchy tags, flickering lights) and only lets the "important" visitors in.

### The Super-Sensing Gatekeeper (YOU!):

Your doorman is on vacation! He leaves the door WIDE OPEN.

- **The Struggle:** All the visitors come in at once! The noise, the lights, the smells. It gets crowded and loud in your brain.
- **The Super Power:** You also let in the beautiful things! You notice the tiny sparkle on a rock. You hear the song of a bird that no one else hears. You feel big love for your friends.

### The Reframing:

You aren't "broken." You are just **High Definition**. You see the world in 4K, while others see it in standard.

## PAGE 7: SCENARIO CHALLENGE

# WHAT WOULD YOU DO?

### The Situation:

You are at a birthday party. It is very loud. Kids are popping balloons (BANG!). The lights are flashing. Your "Volume Dial" is hitting the RED zone. You feel like you might cry or scream.

### Option A: The Explosion

Scream "SHUT UP!" and throw the cake on the floor. (This might make things worse).

### Option B: The Silent Sufferer

Stand in the corner and feel terrible, hoping it ends soon.

### Option C: The Cozy Secret

Use your brave words: *"This is too loud for me. I'm going to step into the hall for a minute."*  
Then, use Gentle Grounding.

**My Choice is:** \_\_\_\_\_

# PARENT GUIDE: The Science of Sensory Safety

This workbook supports children with **Sensory Processing Sensitivity (SPS)** or 2e profiles.

## 1. Interoceptive Awareness (The Volume Dial)

Many neurodivergent children struggle to recognize their internal state until they are already in crisis (flooded). The "Volume Dial" teaches them to scan their body *before* they hit the red zone.

- *Tip:* Ask "What is your number?" or "What color is your dial?" regularly, not just when they are upset.

## 2. Environmental Modification (The Cozy Cocoon)

This empowers the child to change their environment rather than just "toughening up." A "Cocoon" creates a low-sensory recovery zone.

- *Why it works:* It reduces cortisol (stress hormone) levels, allowing the nervous system to reset.

## 3. Sensory Grounding (Gentle Grounding)

When a child is overwhelmed, their amygdala (threat detection) is firing. Gentle sensory input (soft textures, rhythmic sounds) signals safety to the brain.

## 4. Self-Advocacy (Ask for What I Need)

The ultimate goal is for the child to verbalize needs: *"It's too loud"* rather than acting out behaviors.



## PAGE 9: POCKET CARDS

# YOUR CALM POCKET CARDS

*Instructions: Cut these out and keep them in your pocket for emergencies!*

| TOOL 1: VOLUME DIAL                                                                                                                  | TOOL 2: COCOON                                                                                        |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  "Check your Dial!"                                 |  "I need my Cocoon." |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Am I Green? (Calm)</li><li>• Am I Yellow? (Wobbly)</li><li>• Am I Red? (Too Much!)</li></ul> | <p>Use this when: The world is too loud, bright, or fast. It's okay to take a break!</p>              |

### TOOL 3: GROUNDING

#### "5 Senses Check"

- See 1 soft thing
- Hear 1 quiet thing
- Touch 1 smooth thing

### TOOL 4: BRAVE WORDS

#### "This is too much."

Say: "My ears are hurting. Can we turn it down?" or "I need a quiet minute."



# COZY EXPERT AWARD



This certifies that

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Has successfully learned the **Cozy Secrets**:

✓ **Checking the Volume Dial**

✓ **Building a Cozy Cocoon**

✓ **Using Gentle Grounding**

✓ **Asking for What I Need**

**"I promise to listen to my body and be kind to my super-senses!"**

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*Cozy Expert Signature*